

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

How was your trip? Was the traffic OK?



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What kinds of things do you talk about when you meet someone new?
- What topics are common for small talk in your country?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about experiences I've had and haven't had.
- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can make small talk.





Let's Explore!

Adam goes to a job interview. What is the first "real*" question he is asked?

* "Real" conversation as opposed to small talk.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Interviewer: You must be Adam.

Adam: Hi Mr. Mitchell. Pleasure to meet you.

Interviewer: Likewise. How are you?

Adam: I'm good, thanks. Yourself?

Interviewer: Not bad. How was your trip? Was the traffic OK?

Adam: Yes, everything was fine, thanks.

Interviewer: Our HR team was quite content with your phone interview, congratulations.

Adam: Thanks.

Interviewer: Alright, why don't you tell me about yourself?

Adam: I'm a motivated, eager individual looking to work in a dynamic, fast-moving industry.

Interviewer: That's good. We're looking for ambitious, dynamic copywriters with talent and drive. Tell me more about your educational background.

Adam: I graduated in communications from Boston University. I've taken many courses to help me perform well in this position.

Interviewer: What work experience have you had?

Adam: I've worked with close-knit teams. I've also had the chance to develop relationships with a diverse range of clients.

Interviewer: Could you be more specific?

Adam: Sure. I've worked at the University newspaper and the local Boston Review, both with a group and independently. This has provided me with what I believe to be a solid foundation for this position.

Interviewer: Are you more interested in a steady job with benefits and holiday entitlement or one that will allow you to advance quickly?

Adam: I don't want to hit a glass ceiling. I want to grow and move up the corporate ladder.

Interviewer: Would you be able to relocate?

Adam: I am open to relocating.

Interviewer: What are your annual salary requirements?

Adam: I need at least 65,000 a year.

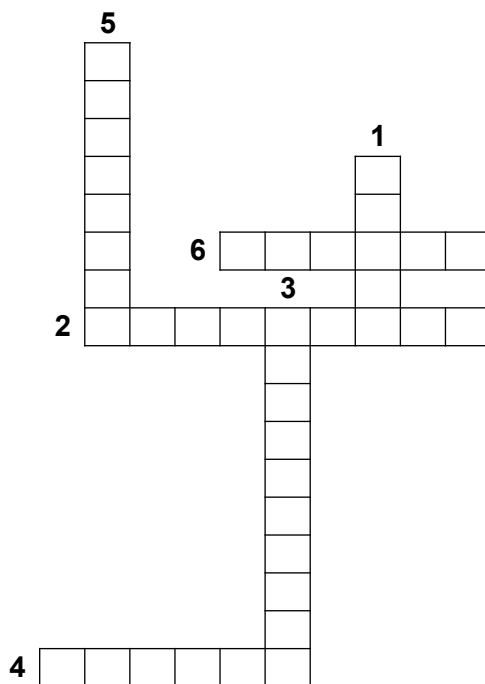
Interviewer: I'll keep that in mind. Thank you for coming in today. We'll be in touch.





Instructions: complete the crossword. First, read the clue. Then, write your answer.

2. I've worked on _____ teams.
4. I've also had the _____ to develop relationships with a diverse range of clients.
6. I've _____ at the University newspaper and the local Boston Review.



Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Likewise / You must be / everything was fine / Was the traffic / Pleasure to / Yourself

Adam: Yes, _____, thanks.





Extension Activity

Talk about your experience.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of a dream job.
- Write down five skills you think you need to do that job well.
- Then, think of how your experience can contribute to each skill.
- Share your information with a partner and practice a job interview.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I consider how my experience can apply to my dream job.

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I discuss my experience with a partner.

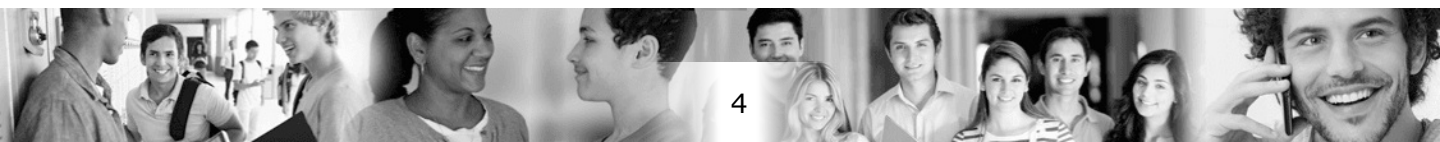
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We simulate a job interview.

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Target Words

- **solid foundation** (expression): good basis of experience and education in preparation for a job
e.g. This experience has provided me with a solid foundation for this position.
- **benefits** (noun): extra advantages of working at a company, such as healthcare and dental insurance
e.g. Are you more interested in a steady job with benefits and holiday entitlement or one that will allow you to advance quickly?
- **glass ceiling** (expression): the feeling that you cannot advance in a company, even though it appears you can
e.g. I don't want to hit a glass ceiling.
- **corporate ladder** (noun): the hierarchy in a company that describes who is in charge of whom
e.g. I want to grow and move up the corporate ladder.
- **salary requirements** (noun): the amount of money you expect to earn in a job
e.g. What are your annual salary requirements?





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense - Talking About Experiences

You use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You can use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about experience.

When you use the **Present Perfect tense**, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

It is common to hear and use the **Present Perfect Tense** in interviews, since you talk about things you did in the past that connect to the present job.

For example:

***I've worked** with close-knit teams.*

= I worked with close-knit teams in the past and now I am familiar with that style of work.

Examples:

- ***I've worked** with close-knit teams.*
- ***I've also had** the chance to develop relationships with a diverse range of clients.*
- ***This has provided** me with what I believe to be a solid foundation for this position.*
- ***I've worked** at the University newspaper and the local Boston Review, both with a group and independently.*
- ***I've taken** many courses to help me perform well in this position.*

Small Talk

You use small talk (a casual form of conversation) to "break the ice" or fill an awkward silence between people. It is common to use small talk at work when you talk to coworkers and when you meet someone new.

There are certain "safe" topics that people usually make small talk about. Talking about the weather is a common small talk topic. Another one is the traffic or local news. For example:

Interviewer: You must be Adam.

Adam: Hi, Mr. Mitchell. Pleasure to meet you.

Interviewer: Likewise. How are you?

Adam: I'm good thanks. Yourself?

Interviewer: Not bad. How was your trip? Was the traffic OK?

Adam: Yes, everything was fine, thanks.

This is a typical small talk conversation between two people who do not know each other. It creates a comfortable, friendly atmosphere.

